



PROGRESS REPORT

New investments: progress report, 2025-08-01 to 2026-08-27

Edition of 2026-08-27-2 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

3 places. Every table below is carried verbatim from that place's own progress report; nothing is written here.

AFRICA · SOUTHERN AFRICA · WEST AFRICA

Movement values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

Africa

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-27	MOVEMENT
African technology equity and debt funding	US\$3.25bn in total equity and debt funding across 534 deals in 2024	US\$4.1bn in 2025, up about 25% year on year and the strongest level since 2022, across 570 deals, up 7%; debt reached its highest volume ever at US\$1.6bn, up 63% on a 40% rise in the number of debt transactions and making up almost half of total capital raised, while equity funding grew 8% on a broadly stable deal count, so the growth came through larger ticket sizes rather than more transactions	ADVANCED
Development agency shift from aid delivery to investment mobilisation	Did not exist	A United Nations development agency told its executive board that its finance model is shifting from delivering aid to using scarce public resources to unlock investment at scale, citing official development assistance down 23.3% in 2025 with a further fall expected	ADVANCED
Digital Africa Seed Fund	Did not exist	A closed-end seed-stage fund with a ten-year horizon, sized at EUR 30m with a hard cap of EUR 50m, targeting 30 startups across 20 priority African countries at an average first ticket of EUR 300,000, and positioned as the seed step between the sponsor's pre-seed vehicle and institutional Series A investors	ADVANCED
Digitalisation of cooperative agricultural financial institutions	Did not exist	EUR 12,000,000 committed by a bilateral development ministry to digitalise cooperative agricultural financial institutions in West Africa	ADVANCED
Foundation call for AI in family planning	Did not exist	A private foundation opened a call for proposals using artificial intelligence to widen access to digital contraception information across sub-Saharan Africa, offering up to US\$500,000 a project, with applications closing on 25 August 2026	ADVANCED
Hewlett Foundation grant to BudgIT (general operating support)	Did not exist	US\$1,000,000 committed (US\$500,000 disbursed) as general operating support to BudgIT's budget-transparency and civic-tech work	ADVANCED

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-27	MOVEMENT
Hewlett Foundation grant to BudgIT (learning systems and communications)	Did not exist	US\$50,000 committed and fully disbursed to strengthen BudgIT's learning systems and strategic communications	ADVANCED
Hewlett Foundation grant to Cenfri (digital transformation programme)	Did not exist	US\$300,000 committed (US\$150,000 disbursed) to renew Cenfri's work on digital transformation and its link to evidence-informed policymaking across Africa	ADVANCED
Hewlett Foundation grant to Data4Change (Data Hub: Africa)	Did not exist	US\$400,000 committed (US\$200,000 disbursed) to Data4Change's Africa Hub, building community-generated evidence for policy and practice in East and West Africa	ADVANCED
Hewlett Foundation grant to ICED (AI-enabled evidence generation)	Did not exist	US\$100,000 committed and fully disbursed for the International Centre for Evaluation and Development to adopt AI-enabled evidence generation institution-wide	ADVANCED
IFC equity investment in Jumia	Did not exist	US\$25m of IFC equity inside a wider US\$50m raise	ADVANCED
Mergers and acquisitions in the digital economy	68 deals across the whole of 2025	84 deals worth an estimated US\$11.4bn in disclosed value between 1 January and 17 August 2026	ADVANCED
Share of funded African tech startups led by a female chief executive	17 of 178 funded ventures, 9.6%, taking 7.9% of the capital (2025)	5 of 60, 8.3%, taking 2.8% of the capital (2026 to May)	REGRESSED
TaxDev III (IFS tax and social-protection policy data programme)	Did not exist	Institute for Fiscal Studies programme, funded by the UK's FCDO, building tax and social-protection policy data resources and tools with finance ministries and revenue authorities in Ethiopia, Ghana, Kenya, Nigeria, Rwanda and Uganda; about US\$6.36m disbursed 2023-2026	ADVANCED
Wind-down of a blockchain backer of African startups	An operating blockchain with a fund and accelerator pipeline backing African early-stage companies	The Swiss operator said on 25 August 2026 that it will discontinue its blockchain on 31 October 2026 and wind down its governance organisation, ending a funding and accelerator pipeline that had backed African companies in Nigeria, South Africa and Rwanda; it cited chain revenue insufficient to support its token, proposes burning 100 million tokens to cut supply from 400 million to 300 million, and has arranged a migration path for projects onto another chain. African blockchain startups raised US\$90.1m in 2025, down 26.6% on the year	CLOSED
EU Multiannual Indicative Programme for Sub-Saharan Africa 2021-2027	EUR 490m for priority area 4, Digital and Science, Technology and Innovation, of which EUR 240m for digital transformation, within a regional envelope of EUR 12,000m	Unchanged; the mid-term review cut priority area 4 from EUR 1,240m to EUR 490m and its digital transformation component from EUR 940m to EUR 240m, or 2.0 per cent of an envelope enlarged from EUR 10,242m to EUR 12,000m, and no later amendment is held	NO CHANGE
Africa Finance Corporation digital bond	Baseline not held	CHF 350m raised on a five-year digital bond listed, traded and settled on a regulated digital exchange — stated as the first by an African institution — priced at a 1.4925% coupon and arranged by two European banks; it is the issuer's fourth and largest Swiss franc issuance	BASELINE NOT HELD
Africa50 Infrastructure Acceleration Fund	BASELINE NOT HELD	Fourth close of about US\$330m, joined by British International Investment's US\$20m commitment alongside the African Development Bank, the International Finance Corporation and more than 20 African institutional investors; the fund, managed by Africa Infrastructure Investment Partners, directs capital to logistics, power, water and sanitation and social infrastructure as well as digital connectivity; the size and date of earlier closes are not established	Baseline not held

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-27	MOVEMENT
AI 10 Billion Initiative	Did not exist	Launched, with a ten-month partnership roadshow to follow	BASELINE NOT HELD
BIASHARA 2063 project (AU Commission institutional systems)	BASELINE NOT HELD	A World Bank-financed programme building the Commission's own institutions and systems, procuring wireless infrastructure for its headquarters; no envelope, timetable or results framework held	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Capital raised by startups from a technology company's African accelerators	Baseline not held	More than US\$1bn raised cumulatively since 2017, with a stated survival rate above 90% against a 70-80% failure rate for the wider ecosystem (2026-08)	BASELINE NOT HELD
Development-finance and infrastructure-fund partnership	Baseline not held	A British development finance institution and a continental infrastructure fund announced a strengthened partnership to scale infrastructure financing across Africa, connectivity among the named sectors; no commitment amount, fund vehicle, country allocation or timetable is published	BASELINE NOT HELD
Growth-capital investment in a pan-African messaging infrastructure provider	Baseline not held	US\$12m into a provider of application-to-person messaging — one-time passwords, transaction alerts and delivery updates — operating across 35 African countries through 15 operator partnerships	BASELINE NOT HELD
KOICA Youth Leadership Programme	BASELINE NOT HELD	US\$34m stated by Korea for a programme coupling public governance and policy development with artificial-intelligence-driven digital government, hosted by the Ghana Institute of Management and Public Administration for 200 participants from Ghana, Nigeria, Cote d'Ivoire, Senegal and Cameroon, in three phases - online training, in-country sessions, and a funded 14-day study visit to Korea for the best performers	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Limited-partner commitments to African private-capital funds	Baseline not held	64 commitments in the second quarter of 2026 against 53 a year earlier, with disclosed value of US\$272m against US\$847m in the same quarter of 2025 and US\$1.18bn in the first quarter of 2026; no disclosed commitment above US\$50m, and information technology appeared in 61% of commitments against 17% a year earlier	BASELINE NOT HELD
LINGUA Africa language-model grants	Baseline not held	26 projects covering more than 50 African languages, dialects and sign languages across 47 countries, each awardee eligible for up to US\$250,000 in cash and US\$400,000 in compute credits; health, agriculture and justice are the stated use cases	BASELINE NOT HELD
Stage mix of a development financier's African portfolio	Not held	79% of one development financier's African deals are at Series B or later, so it operates less like a venture fund than a later-stage investor	BASELINE NOT HELD

Southern Africa

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-27	MOVEMENT
Botswana Tech Fund	Did not exist	First phase of GBP 5m against a GBP 50m target, backing pre-seed and growth companies across Southern Africa	ADVANCED
UK science and technology accelerator programme	BASELINE NOT HELD	A three-year programme of up to GBP2.5m out to expressions of interest, covering artificial intelligence and emerging technologies and digital access and inclusion alongside climate, energy, health and space, with a primary focus on South Africa and a first-year focus on Zimbabwe and Zambia	<i>Baseline not held</i>

West Africa

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-27	MOVEMENT
Digital Transformation Fund (BOAD/KfW)	Did not exist	A joint fund of the West African Development Bank and the German development bank carrying an envelope of 71 billion FCFA for digital modernisation of public administrations across the eight monetary-union states, with a published six-step instruction and validation process, a named focal point in each member state, and eligibility terms of a maximum 24-month project, a budget ceiling of 2,500 million FCFA, an interest rate the fund states at 2.2% and obligatory partial state co-financing; no date of signature or entry into force, no country allocation and no committed or disbursed total is published	ADVANCED
WARDIP (Western Africa Regional Digital Integration Program)	The first series alone: US\$293.00m across four states, ECOWAS, the African Union and Smart Africa	A second series approved on 2026-03-11 for Benin, Liberia and Sierra Leone, with Liberia's US\$50m share signed in June	ADVANCED
World Bank commitment to the WARDIP series	US\$293.00m, the first series (2023-11-07)	US\$430.00m across the two series, after US\$137.00m was approved on 2026-03-11	ADVANCED
Pooled equity investment in a pan-African start-up fund	Baseline not held	EUR10.5m approved toward first close - EUR7m from the continental development bank and EUR3.5m from the European Union with the African, Caribbean and Pacific states - into a fund investing in agribusiness, financial services, energy, education and health, mainly in Francophone West Africa	BASELINE NOT HELD

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.